

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments product owner for regulated, high-stakes merchants.*

Positioning, I have shipped payments products in regulated fintech for 13 years, from a P2P payment startup acquired by Sparkasse to PSP integrations in insurance and retail.

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Dear UniqPay team,

Acquiring, payouts, FX, and risk for merchants in regulated verticals is where I have spent most of my product career. I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions in 2013 as a mobile P2P payment product, took it through scheme compliance inside the girocard ecosystem, and eventually to acquisition by Sparkasse. Since then I have run backlogs in insurance, healthcare, public-sector data, and defence AI, always in regulated environments where a missed acceptance criterion has real downstream consequences.

The Product Owner role at UniqPay asks for someone who can translate licensing conditions, KYC and KYB rules, AML monitoring, and card scheme requirements into sprint-ready stories across multiple jurisdictions. I have done this directly. At EMIL Group I shipped the Claims Center and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week by structuring regulatory constraints as product requirements rather than as blockers. At Scheidt & Bachmann I worked across acquiring, POS, and forecourt payments in a full SAFe setup, moving research into production through a matrix organisation. Both environments required the same thing UniqPay requires: clear scope decisions under regulatory pressure, explained consistently to engineers, compliance, and commercial stakeholders in the same meeting.

What draws me specifically to UniqPay is the scope of the problem: iGaming, Crypto, and FX merchants operating across corridors where local payment methods, settlement rails, and regulatory obligations all change at once. My crypto domain knowledge is hands-on, I actively trade and manage positions across Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, and cross-chain bridges, and I understand the on/off-ramp and settlement dynamics that make these merchants hard to serve. That is not background reading; it is the same product knowledge your regulated merchants use to evaluate whether a payments partner actually understands their business.

I write user stories that cover payment edge cases, cascading, retries, chargebacks, partial settlements, FX rounding, because I have been burned by stories that did not. I track approval rates and settlement accuracy as primary product metrics, not as reporting artefacts. And I say no clearly when a backlog item does not serve the roadmap, which I can explain to a founder, a compliance officer, and an engineer in the same breath.

I would like to talk about the acquiring and payout platform specifically and where you see the biggest gaps in the current backlog.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
